Variables and input

Programming · Level 2 · Lesson 2



In this lesson you will

- Store and change values in variables.
- Ask with input() and turn text into a number with int().
- Explain why "5" + "3" is "53".

Key ideas

- = stores: score = score + 5 adds 5.
- input() always gives text.
- int() turns text into a number.

Activity: Label the boxes

1. Warm-up (3 min): Draw a box called score with 20 in it.
2. Trace (7 min): Follow a program, changing the box each line.
3. Predict (7 min): What do "5" + "3" and 5 + 3 give?
4. Check (3 min): Run it and compare.

Paper boxes work well: a variable is a box that holds one value at a time.

Let’s discuss

1. Why does input() give text, not a number?
2. What does score = score + 5 mean in words?
3. Which error have you met today?

Exit ticket

- Write two lines: ask for a number, and print it doubled.